

MEMORANDUM TO THE FILE

Subj: USE OF OTHER THAN FULL AND OPEN COMPETITION FOR AN ACQUISITION UNDER THE SIMPLIFIED ACQUISITION THRESHOLD

I. BACKGROUND:

1. FAR 12.102 states document decisions to restrict competition, including the use of brand-name descriptions without allowing for “equal” products.
2. FAR 12.202(a) states for acquisitions valued at or below the simplified acquisition threshold (SAT), document the decision that only one source is available and the basis for the decision.
3. GSAR 538.7104-4(b)(2)(i) If the order is to be placed (or FSS BPA established) competitively, the file must be documented concerning the basis for restricting consideration to an item peculiar to one manufacturer.

II. DESCRIPTION OF ITEM OR SERVICE:

- DELL PowerEdge
- Model Number: R6515 8x2.5” Chassis
- Quantity: 10

A single-socket rackmount server optimized for high-density storage and compute-intensive workloads. The chassis supports up to eight 2.5-inch SAS/SATA hot-plug drives, up to 16 DDR4 DIMM slots (supporting up to 2TB LRDIMM), 3rd Generation AMD EPYC processors, and includes iDRAC9 Enterprise for remote management, which will support the AMAG system at NAS Jacksonville.

Standard specifications for each Dell PowerEdge R6515 8x2.5” server:

- 1 x Dell PowerEdge R6515 8x2.5" Chassis
- 1 x Dell Trusted Platform Module (TPM) 2.0 for 14G CPU
- 1 x Dell AMD EPYC 7282 Processor (2.8GHz, 16C, 64MB Cache) Memory
- 2 x 16GB DDR4 RDIMM 3200MT/s Storage Controller
- 1 x PERC H740P 8GB Lvl 0-60 Mini Mono RAID Drives
- 2 x Dell 960GB SATA 2.5" Solid State Drive RAID Configuration
- 1 x RAID 1 Onboard Networking
- 1 x On-Board Dual Port 1GbE LOM PCIE Adapter
- 1 x Dell Broadcom 5719 Quad Port 1GbE BASE-T Network Adapter Optical Drive
- 1 x No Optical Drive Remote Access
- 1 x iDRAC9 Express Remote Access Card - Remote Monitoring Functions Only Rails
- 1 x No Rails Cable Management Arm
- 1 x No Cable Management Arm Bezel
- 1 x No Bezel Power Supply Unit
- 1 x (2) Dell 14G 15G 550 Watt PSU Colocation

- 1 x No Colocation Warranty
- 1 x TekShield Support as Available with Replacement for 1 Year (Parts Only)

III. THE DETERMINATION FOR USE OF OTHER THAN FULL AND OPEN COMPETITION IS BASED ON THE FOLLOWING:

A. **ONLY ONE RESPONSIBLE SOURCE (select all that apply):**

1. **RESTRICTIVE RIGHTS.** The source has established proprietary rights, limited rights in data, patent rights, copyrights or secret processes in the item or service required.
2. **EXCLUSIVE LICENSING AGREEMENTS.** The item or service is only available from the Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM), or there is only one authorized distributor or technical representative for the OEM.
3. **OTHER REASONS.** Mixing server brands requires the N6-IT team to manage different administrative tools. While Dell utilizes **iDRAC** for embedded management, other vendors use different proprietary systems like HP's iLO, which increases the learning curve and potential for configuration errors during critical missions. The rails are specifically designed for DELL server racks and purchasing a different brand, new rails would also need to purchase new rails to mount the servers in.

B. BRAND NAME. The Dell PowerEdge R6515 is not a commodity server; it is a proprietary ecosystem. While other companies (like HPE or Lenovo) manufacture single-socket AMD servers, they utilize different firmware, management chipsets, and physical architecture. The iDRAC9 (Integrated Dell Remote Access Controller) is a proprietary hardware-on-motherboard solution. It is the only tool that integrates with the Government's existing OpenManage Enterprise console. A third-party "equivalent" would require a separate management infrastructure, doubling the administrative burden. While other products may meet the "8x2.5-inch chassis" requirement, they fail to meet the **functional requirement** of being a drop-in replacement that maintains 100% uptime through existing support contracts and technician training.

C. UNUSUAL AND COMPELLING URGENCY. The supplies or services are of such unusual and compelling urgency that the Government would be seriously injured unless the agency is permitted to limit the number of sources from which it solicits bids or proposals. Urgent requirements are supplies or services that will result in a work stoppage, or are mission critical and the routine processing time would result in injury to the Government. The determination that the procurement for the above item/service is an urgent and compelling requirement is based on the following:

1. Date on which the requirement was first identified:
2. Required delivery date/period of performance:
3. Explanation of why delivery/commencement of services by the date mentioned above is required:

4. If appropriate, include any additional pertinent information.

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